

Amendment No. 1 to HB2167

White
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 2634

House Bill No. 2167*

by deleting all language after the caption and substituting:

WHEREAS, Tennessee is known as the Volunteer State in part due to its proud tradition of civic participation, community service, and volunteerism that reflects the values of its people; and

WHEREAS, Colby's Law is intended to further our State's proud history for generations to come by ensuring that all public institutions of higher learning across the State create meaningful opportunities for their students to embrace their duty of civic engagement through participation in the electoral process; and

WHEREAS, removing academic barriers to student participation in general election day events has proven to increase student voter turnout and volunteerism in elections and campaign activities; and

WHEREAS, Colby's Law is also consistent with the value that academia places on volunteerism in that encouraging students to engage in their communities through dedicated student service hours on general election day would be beneficial to both the student and the community; now, therefore,

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 2, Chapter 1, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

(a) This section is known and may be cited as "Colby's Law."

(b) Each public institution of higher education shall, on the date of a general election, implement reasonable measures to promote civic engagement and facilitate

student participation in the election process, such as providing information about voting locations, encouraging community volunteerism and service for civic engagement, and removing unnecessary barriers for student participation in the electoral process.

(c) An institution may observe an academic holiday on the date of a general election. An institution that elects to observe an academic holiday on the date of a general election is not required to close the institution or to suspend its operations, including, but not limited to, clinical programs, research activities, internships, practicums, professional programs, online education, student services, health services, public safety operations, or any other essential institutional function.

(d) As used in this section:

(1) "Academic holiday" means a day on which a public institution of higher education has elected to suspend or modify regularly scheduled in-person instructional activities, as determined by the institution; and

(2) "General election" means a statewide or federal general election held in November of an even-numbered year and does not include a municipal or local election, a special election, or an election held outside of this state.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.